

You will be assimilated



Maulik Jasubhai Publisher

THERE WAS A time when most of us were uncomfortable with making a simple transaction on the internet with our credit cards. We are at the same stage of 'evolution' in our thinking when it comes to providing our vital statistics to an unknown unnamed 'entity'. We had better get over this dis-comfort in a hurry! Bio-Metric data collections and security measures are here to stay and much to our dismay they are likely to get a lot more 'intrusive' than we have ever imagined them to be.

As we move towards a more connected world, all of us are involved in transactions which involve multiple agencies. Imagine the next time you want to use your cell phone to make a call, collect airline frequent flyer miles, make a purchase, or even register for a newsletter from a content provider; unless we have fool proof system to identify and confirm that you are the authorizing agent none of it will be possible and prone to massive frauds.

Today companies and enterprises are under enormous pressure to maintain the confidentiality and security of their data. At the same time it has become a lot easier for hackers to crack your personal passwords and access codes. Let me ask you, how many of you regularly change

your access passwords? Or how often have you given your password to your friend or colleague so that he/she may use your computer/files? My guess is, not often enough and too often, respectively. How do we protect information from being misused? As the miscreants become more sophisticated and as we start using our digital footprint across numerous applications, it will be critical to accurately identify you as the authorized individual. Bio-Metric identification and networks using your personal information, either the finger prints or the iris patterns, will be less prone to attacks and will certainly remove the false impressions of being safe, just because they use passwords.

Of course, there is a downside to this! Your privacy is under siege. You are now part of a world wide grid that not only identifies you accurately but also knows your entire personal history. It is conceivable that your most intimate information may be used to 'analyze' and then 'categorize' you. Your finger prints, your iris maps, even your DNA and genetic structure become a part of the massive database that forms the part of this grid. Insurance companies may use this data to deny you insurance because they have used the data and used some algorithm to classify you as high risk. Countries have used this data and another algorithm to classify you as potential 'security threat'. Companies may use this data and use yet another algorithm to determine your personality and therefore deny you the promotion that you may well have earned. All in all we will be reduced to a set of numbers derived from our private information using a formula devised by a mathematical geek sitting in his basement.

**"Resistance is futile.
You will be assimilated!"**
— Locutus of Borg,
Star Trek-The Next Generation

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Maulik Jasubhai'.

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